PADHAKU
Kaveri · Class 9 English

CHAPTER 5

The World of Limitless Possibilities

NCERT Exercise Solutions

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✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡
answers are a guide, not a script. Write your own!
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The World of Limitless Possibilities · Reflect and Respond

I 1 **Look at the picture of Sheetal Devi, a para-archer honoured with the Arjuna Award (January 2024). Share your observations.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Sheetal Devi is aiming an arrow with great focus and balance.

She uses her leg and body to hold and draw the bow, showing great skill and confidence. (check the picture in your book)

I 2 **Does this personality inspire you? Explain how.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Yes. She shows that hard work and courage can overcome any physical challenge.

She teaches me not to give up when things are difficult.

I 3 **Give a caption for this picture.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Aiming High: Where There's a Will, There's a Way

II **Complete the table about Paralympics: What I know / What I want to know.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

What I know	What I want to know
Paralympics are games for athletes with disabilities.	How did the Paralympics begin?

They are held after the Olympics in the same city.	Which sports are played in the Paralympics?
India has won many medals in them.	Who are India's top Paralympians?

The World of Limitless Possibilities · Check Your Understanding

I **Fill in the fact table based on the interview with Dr. Deepa Malik.**

✔ ANSWER

Fact	Answer
1. diagnosed with spinal tumour at the age of	29
2. result of the surgery	paralysed waist down; bound to a wheelchair for life
3. named one of the 10 most inspirational women para-athletes by	the International Paralympic Committee
4. first successful Paralympic event	2016 Rio Paralympic Games – silver medal in shot-put
5. list of 'firsts'	(i) first Indian female para-athlete to win an Asian Games medal in athletics (ii) India's first female Paralympics medallist across any sport
6. awards won	(i) Khel Ratna (ii) Arjuna Award (iii) Padma Shri

7. two things supported by her	(i) emotional health of persons with challenges and empowering women through outdoor sports and adventure (ii) persons from lower socio-economic strata, by giving equipment to para sportspersons

II (1) **(i) In the 2016 Rio Paralympic Games, I secured the silver medal in the shot-put event.**
(ii) I feel it was a moment of personal victory and a step forward in changing perceptions.
Fact-opinion or cause-effect?

✔ ANSWER

Fact-opinion. (i) is a fact that can be proved; (ii) is her opinion ('I feel').

II (2) **(i) I was diagnosed with a tumour in my spine.**
(ii) I had a surgery and was told that I would be bound to a wheelchair for the rest of my life.
Fact-opinion or cause-effect?

✔ ANSWER

Cause-effect. The tumour (cause) led to the surgery and the wheelchair (effect).

III (i) **Dr. Deepa Malik was a member of the Working Group for the Formulation of Twelfth Five Year Plan (2012–17).**

It is believed that she contributed greatly to create better sports policies for the persons with disabilities.

Write 1 (cause-effect) or 2 (fact-opinion).

✔ ANSWER

2 (fact-opinion). The first is a fact; 'It is believed' shows an opinion.

III (ii) **Paralympics showcases incredible talent and determination of para-athletes.**

The global perception on disabilities shifts, inspiring para-athletes to pursue their dreams.

Write 1 (cause-effect) or 2 (fact-opinion).

✔ ANSWER

1 (cause-effect). Showing their talent (cause) changes how the world sees disability (effect).

⭐ The World of Limitless Possibilities · Critical Reflection

I 1 (i) **Extract 1 ('I had two choices...'). Give a reason: the speaker's decision to transform her life can be likened to a caterpillar transforming into a butterfly.**

✔ ANSWER

Like a caterpillar that becomes a beautiful butterfly, she changed a life of pain and paralysis into a life of success and 'limitless possibilities'.

I 1 (ii) **Why could the speaker switch to para-athletics quite comfortably?**

✔ ANSWER

Because she loved sports and had been a swimmer too.

I 1 (iii) **The speaker calls 2016 Rio Paralympic Games a 'breakthrough moment' because ____.**

✔ ANSWER

she **secured the silver medal in the shot-put event** there; it was a personal victory and a step forward in changing perceptions.

I 1 (iv) **The phrase 'in hindsight' indicates the speaker is ____. A. curious B. reflective C. determined D. courageous**

✔ ANSWER

B. reflective – she is looking back and thinking about a past event.

I 1 (v) **List one likely perception the speaker might have changed.**

✔ ANSWER

That people with disabilities cannot achieve success in sports (or that a woman in a wheelchair cannot win medals).

I 2 (i) **Extract 2 ('Honestly, I feel sports...'). Choose the words describing the tone: A. appreciative B.**

moralistic C. sentimental D. optimistic E. defensive. (a) A and D (b) B, D and E (c) B and C (d) A, C and E

✔ ANSWER

(a) A and D – she appreciates sports and is hopeful about changing attitudes.

I 2 (ii) **Complete the analogy: ability : potential :: preconceived notions : ____**

✔ ANSWER

stereotypes

I 2 (iii) **True or false: Paralympics is a platform that not only showcases the remarkable abilities of para-athletes but also questions stereotypes.**

✔ ANSWER

True. She says Paralympics challenge stereotypes and break down preconceived notions.

I 2 (iv) **What does 'helped me push boundaries' tell us about the speaker?**

✔ ANSWER

She kept going beyond her limits and achieved more than people expected. She is determined and never gives up.

I 2 (v) **Which phrase from the extract suggests that the speaker was able to transform her life?**

✔ ANSWER

'a new lease of life'

II 1 Explain how Dr. Malik's achievements challenge societal perceptions.

✔ ANSWER

People often underestimated persons with disabilities. Dr. Malik won a Paralympic silver medal, an Asian Games medal and top awards like Khel Ratna and Padma Shri.

Her success proves that 'physical limitations don't define one's potential' and breaks preconceived notions.

II 2 What can be the long-term impact of involving youth in schools and colleges in advocacy with respect to disability?

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Young people will grow up with respect and empathy for persons with disabilities.

As 'the voice of tomorrow', they will help build an inclusive society where everyone gets dignity and a fair chance.

II 3 Rationalise the appropriateness of the title with reference to Dr. Deepa Malik's attitude and achievements.

✔ ANSWER

The title 'The World of Limitless Possibilities' fits well. After paralysis she chose not to waste her life in regret but to 'transform it to a world of limitless possibilities'.

Her positive attitude led to many 'firsts', medals and awards, showing that there are no limits for a determined person.

II 4 **'Every setback is an opportunity to prove your strength.' How might this be a life lesson for every individual, not just sportspersons?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Everyone faces failures – in studies, work or health. If we see a setback as a chance to learn and try harder, we grow stronger.

A student who fails a test can work harder and do better next time.

II 5 **Examine how Dr. Deepa Malik's recognition as one of the 10 most inspirational para-athletes globally contributes to the larger discourse on gender equality in sports.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Her recognition shows that women, even with disabilities, can reach the top in sports.

It encourages more girls to take up sports and pushes society to give women equal support and chances. She also works to empower women through outdoor sports and adventure.

II 6 **How might Dr. Deepa Malik's thought, 'ability beyond disability', serve as a guideline for success for all future para-athletes?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

It tells para-athletes to focus on what they can do, not on what they cannot.

With self-belief, hard work and a support system, they can turn their disability into 'a unique strength waiting to be unleashed'.

Q 7 What have you learnt from this interview, and how can you implement these learnings in your life?

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

I learnt never to give up and to treat challenges as opportunities.

I will work hard even when I fail, keep a positive attitude, and treat everyone, including persons with disabilities, with respect and equality.

⭐ The World of Limitless Possibilities · Vocabulary and Structures in Context

I Match the phrases with their meanings and use them in sentences.

✔ ANSWER

Phrase	Meaning
1. defy the odds	(iii) succeed in doing something when most people think it would result in failure
2. a new lease of life	(v) an occasion when you become more energetic and active than earlier
3. in hindsight	(iv) ability to understand something after it has happened
4. breakthrough moment	(i) a time of significant development or discovery

5. turn obstacles into stepping stones	(ii) overcome challenges and achieve goals

Sentences (sample):

- The small team defied the odds and won the final.
- The new medicine gave my grandfather a new lease of life.
- In hindsight, I should have started studying earlier.
- Winning the state quiz was a breakthrough moment for Riya.
- Successful people turn obstacles into stepping stones.

II **Arrange the movement words on the word cline from slowest to fastest: crawl, amble, walk, jog, saunter, dart, sprint, stroll, run, plod, creep. (Given: Crawl, Amble, Walk, Sprint)**

✔ ANSWER

crawl → creep → plod → amble → stroll → saunter → walk → jog → run → dart → sprint

(stroll and saunter are almost the same pace and may be swapped.)

III **Match the highlighted verbs with their functions (two extra).**

✔ ANSWER

Sentence	Function
1. I **could** hear the audience clapping.	(v) past ability
2. It **couldn't** be helped.	(vi) impossibility
3. I **should** give it my best shot.	(iv) obligation
4. I knew if I tried, I **would** win.	(iii) prediction

Extra: (i) promise, (ii) possibility

IV **Make sentences with the modal verbs for each function given in the table. Mention the function in brackets.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- It could rain this evening. (possibility)
- If I had wings, I could fly to the moon. (unreal ability)
- Could you please open the window? (request)
- You could join the sports club. (suggestion)
- I couldn't lift the heavy box. (inability)
- The bus should be here in five minutes. (probability)
- You should drink more water. (advice)
- Would you help me with this bag? (request)
- As a child, I would play in the park every evening. (past habit)

V (a) **The sentences given above (Interviewer: You've been listed... / Dr. Malik: I love sports...) are in ____ (Direct Speech/Reported Speech). They are ____ sentences (declarative/interrogative/exclamatory/imperative).**

✔ ANSWER

Direct Speech; **declarative** sentences.

V (b) **Note the changes from Direct Speech to Reported Speech in Column 3.**

✔ ANSWER

Dr. Malik: I love sports... → Dr. Malik said that she loved sports...

1. 'said' added
2. that – linking word added
3. I → she
4. love → loved
5. I (so I decided) → she
6. decided → had decided

Interviewer: Your story is indeed a testament... → The interviewer said that her story was indeed...

1. 'said' added
2. that – linking word added
3. Your → her
4. is → was

Dr. Malik: I believe youth... → Dr. Malik says that she believes youth...

1. 'says' added; that – linking word added
2. I → she; tense not changed (believe → believes) because the reporting verb 'says' is in the present tense

VI **Change the conversation (Siya and Tarun) to reported speech: fill blanks 1–4.**

✔ ANSWER

1. Siya said that she **had watched a documentary on the para equestrian event on television the previous night**.
2. Siya added that **it did and that it had been so interesting to watch**.
3. Siya replied that **they also had to find and develop their own style of communication with their horse**.

4. Tarun said that **he would watch that documentary the following weekend**.

The World of Limitless Possibilities · Listen and Respond

I 1 The venue for the special assembly is the ____.

✔ ANSWER

school auditorium

I 2 A presentation on inclusion will be made by the ____.

✔ ANSWER

Interact Club

I 3 The dance performance will focus on the themes of ____ and ____.

✔ ANSWER

diversity and **acceptance**

I 4 A ____ will be conducted by experts who support inclusion.

✔ ANSWER

panel discussion

I 5 The celebration will end with a ____ to encourage team work.

✔ ANSWER

song

The World of Limitless Possibilities · Speaking Activity

I **Interview the Sports Captain (informal) and the Sports Coach (formal) of your school, in pairs.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Formal (Sports Coach) – sample:

Student: Good morning, sir. It is my privilege to have this interaction with you. Could you tell me how your journey in sports began?

Coach: Good morning. I started playing football in school and later played for my state.

Student: Could you share the challenges you faced and how you overcame them?

Coach: Injuries and lack of facilities. Regular practice and support from my family helped me.

Student: You've received many accolades. What do they mean to you?

Coach: They remind me that hard work pays off.

Student: What advice do you have for aspiring athletes?

Coach: Be disciplined, stay fit and never give up.

Informal (Sports Captain): use the same points in friendly language, e.g. 'Hello! I'm so glad you agreed to meet me. Tell me about yourself and your love for sports.'

The World of Limitless Possibilities · Writing Task

II **As the Sports Captain, draft a notice (not more than 50 words) asking interested students to register for**

selection for the Inter-school Athletic Meet. Put it in a box.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

ABC Public School, New Delhi

NOTICE

12 November 2026

Inter-school Athletic Meet – Registration

The Sports Club is organising an Inter-school Athletic Meet on 5 December 2026. Students of Classes 6–12 interested in races, relay, long jump, high jump and shot-put may register with the undersigned by 20 November. Selection trials: 22 November, 8 a.m., school ground.

Rohan Sharma

Sports Captain

(Write it inside a box.)

📘 The World of Limitless Possibilities · Learning Beyond the Text

II **In groups of four, make a presentation on: two lesser-known Paralympic sports, or two Paralympians from India.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Sample plan (two Paralympians from India):

- Slide 1: Topic – Two Indian Paralympians
- Slides 2–3: Origin of Paralympics – Sir Ludwig Guttmann's games for war veterans in England (1948); first Paralympics in Rome, 1960; Bharat's debut in 1968, first medal (swimming) in 1972
- Slides 4–6: Dr. Deepa Malik – silver in shot-put at Rio 2016, Khel Ratna, Arjuna, Padma Shri; Sheetal Devi – para-archer, Arjuna Award 2024

- Slide 7: Conclusion – 'ability beyond disability'

Use pictures, a few words per slide, and let each member present.

⭐ Nine Gold Medals · Reflect and Respond

I **Discuss the difference between Olympics, Special Olympics and Paralympics.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- **Olympics:** international games for top athletes, held every four years.
- **Paralympics:** games for athletes with physical (locomotor), sensory or intellectual disabilities; held soon after the Olympics in the same city.
- **Special Olympics:** sports training and competition for children and adults with intellectual disabilities; aims at acceptance and inclusion.

II **Match 'empathy', 'sympathy' and 'compassion' to the sentences.**

✔ ANSWER

Sentence	Word
I am so sorry for what is happening to you. It is sad, do you want something to eat?	**sympathy**
I can imagine how you feel. I understand that you are upset and why.	**empathy**
I understand why you feel terribly low. I will spend some time with you, so that you don't feel lonely.	**compassion**

III **List the words you associate with 'empathy'.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

understanding, kindness, caring, listening, sharing, feeling, support, respect

⭐ Nine Gold Medals · Check Your Understanding

I **Match the words and phrases with their meanings.**

✔ ANSWER

Word/phrase	Meaning
1. dashed in the dirt	(ii) destroyed
2. stumbled	(iv) step awkwardly, lose balance and almost fall
3. staggered	(i) walk or move with difficulty
4. anguish	(v) extreme pain or suffering
5. asphalt	(iii) a hard black substance used to make roads and paths

II **Identify the gist of each stanza. Write the stanza number.**

✔ ANSWER

Gist	Stanza
1. Spectators cheered and waited for the final event	**2**
2. Runners dashed ahead at the gun shot; one athlete fell	**4**
3. Race finished with nine athletes holding hands, gold medals, standing ovation	**8**

4. Nine determined athletes waited at the starting line	**3**
5. Athletes from all over the country had trained for months	**1**
6. Eight athletes stopped to help the fallen athlete	**6**
7. Nine athletes walked hand in hand; banner of Special Olympics	**7**
8. The young athlete cried in frustration, but something unique happened	**5**

III 1 **Two examples of alliteration from the poem.**

✔ ANSWER

(i) '**s**tumbled and **s**taggered'

(ii) '**r**ace to be **r**un'

III 2 **Give three examples of visual imagery from the poem.**

✔ ANSWER

(i) 'The spectators gathered around the old field'

(ii) 'he stumbled and staggered / And fell to the asphalt'

(iii) 'nine beaming faces' / 'all the nine runners joined hands'

III 3 **Give an example of auditory imagery from the poem.**

✔ ANSWER

'the pistol exploded' (also 'He gave out a cry of frustration and anguish')

III 4 **How does the use of imagery make the poem more appealing?**

✔ ANSWER

Imagery helps us see and hear the race – the crowd, the gun shot, the fall and the smiling faces. We feel as if we are present at the event, so the poem becomes lively and touching.

III 5 **How does the poet's tone change from the beginning to the end of the poem?**

✔ ANSWER

It begins excited and eager (the race is about to start), becomes sad when the boy falls, and ends warm, joyful and admiring when all nine finish together.

III 6 **What is the overall mood created by the poem?**

✔ ANSWER

A mood of warmth, joy and inspiration – it touches the heart.

III 7 **What is the message being conveyed by the poem?**

✔ ANSWER

Kindness, empathy and helping others are more important than winning. True victory lies in togetherness.

⭐ Nine Gold Medals · Critical Reflection

I 1 (i) **Extract 1 (stanza 6). 'Pulled up on their heels' means that the runners ____. A. moved aside B. stopped running C. tried to run faster D. jumped ahead**

✔ ANSWER

B. stopped running

I 1 (ii) **Mention one character trait common to all the eight other runners.**

✔ ANSWER

Kind / empathetic (caring) – they gave up the race to help the boy.

I 1 (iii) **What is the tone of the poet in these lines?**

✔ ANSWER

Admiring and appreciative (touched by their kindness).

I 1 (iv) **How might the young athlete have felt on being helped by the others?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

He must have felt surprised, grateful, happy and comforted.

I 1 (v) **Would you consider this incident as a turning point in the poem? Why?**

✔ ANSWER

Yes. Until here it is a race to win; now the runners stop competing and help the boy, so the poem turns from competition to kindness and togetherness.

I 2 (i) **Extract 2 (stanza 8). How did the nine contestants feel when they reached the finishing line together?**

✔ ANSWER

They felt very happy and proud – they had 'beaming faces'.

I 2 (ii) **Why do you think all the nine contestants were given gold medals?**

✔ ANSWER

Because they all showed kindness and team spirit and finished together as one; each was equally a winner.

I 2 (iii) **The holding of hands signifies a feeling of ____.**

✔ ANSWER

unity and togetherness (friendship)

I 2 (iv) **The spectators giving a 'standing ovation' indicates that they were ____. A. amazed B. speechless C. distracted D. thoughtful**

✔ ANSWER

A. amazed

I 2 (v) **Explain the last line of the extract ('Said more than these words ever will').**

✔ ANSWER

The standing ovation and the happy faces expressed the beauty of the moment better than any words. The poet feels his words cannot fully describe it.

II 1 **Describe how the setting in the first two stanzas creates a vivid atmosphere for the events that follow.**

✔ ANSWER

Athletes from all over the country, months of training, spectators gathered around the old field and the final event approaching create excitement and expectation. We feel the eagerness, so the later fall and the act of kindness feel more powerful.

II 2 **How do you think the youngest athlete might have felt when he fell?**

✔ ANSWER

He must have felt frustrated, sad and hurt, as his dreams and efforts were 'dashed in the dirt'.

II 3 **Why were the athletes eager to begin the race?**

✔ ANSWER

They had trained for many weeks and months, and had come from all over the country to run for gold, silver and bronze. This was their chance to win.

Q 4 **What does the transformation of the hundred-yard dash to a walk symbolise?**

✔ ANSWER

It symbolises that friendship, unity and kindness became more important than speed and winning.

Q 5 **How might the poem be different if the focus was solely on individual achievement rather than collective support?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

The runners would have left the fallen boy behind; one would win and the boy would be alone and sad. The poem would lose its message of empathy and would not be as touching.

Q 6 **How does the poet's use of language and tone enhance the reader's engagement with the poem?**

✔ ANSWER

Simple, storytelling language ('as sure as I'm standing here telling this story'), imagery and a tone that moves from excitement to warmth keep the reader interested and emotionally involved.

Q 7 **What might be the poet's purpose of writing this poem?**

✔ ANSWER

To show that kindness and helping others matter more than winning, and to inspire empathy and inclusion, as the Special Olympics does.

⭐ Nine Gold Medals · Vocabulary in Context

I **'Standing ovation' is an adjective–noun collocation. Identify two other similar examples from the poem.**

✔ ANSWER

beaming faces, **resolved athletes** (also: old field, final event, young boy)

II **Write four nouns that collocate with each adjective (1. big: disappointment, failure, surprise, decision).**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Adjective	Nouns
2. heavy	rain, traffic, loss, meal
3. strong	wind, coffee, opinion, smell
4. large	amount, number, family, crowd
5. great	success, idea, pleasure, deal

III **Choose the correct adjectives from the box (positive, significant, youngest, noisy, loud) for the underlined words.**

✔ ANSWER

1. littlest → **youngest**
2. smiling (attitude) → **positive**
3. huge (cry) → **loud**
4. terrible (difference) → **significant**
5. gaudy (crowd) → **noisy**

⭐ Nine Gold Medals · Listen and Respond

I 1 **Patrick Gomes began his career in sports with track events.**

✔ ANSWER

True – his journey began with track events in 1991, in Chennai.

I 2 **Patrick Gomes has been coaching special athletes for 10 years.**

✔ ANSWER

False – for over 15 years.

I 3 **Patrick Gomes does all the household work himself.**

✔ ANSWER

True – he lives by himself, doing all the daily chores at home.

II 1 **When the speaker uses the phrase 'push your boundaries', he wants listeners to ____.**

✔ ANSWER

(i) challenge themselves

II 2 **Patrick Gomes is a ____ at present.**

✔ ANSWER

(ii) coach of special athletes

II 3 **Special Olympic Games held at Connecticut was a ____ for Patrick Gomes.**

✔ ANSWER

(ii) turning point – 'a milestone in his life, changing his life forever'.

II 4 **As a special athlete, Patrick Gomes mostly participated in ____.**

✔ ANSWER

(iii) football – 'primarily football'.

II 5 **Patrick Gomes believes that sports is essential because it encourages ____ along with fitness.**

✔ ANSWER

(i) a positive outlook – sports brings positivity, fitness and discipline.

🧪 Nine Gold Medals · Speaking Activity

I **In pairs, express your points of view on Special Olympics (importance, impact, creating awareness), using the sentence starters.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

A: What is your opinion on the Special Olympics?

B: Personally, I believe that they promote inclusion. They give persons with intellectual disabilities a chance to play and be respected.

A: How do you feel about their impact on the athletes?

B: I hold the opinion that they build confidence, fitness and friendships, like Patrick Gomes, who became a coach.

A: In your view, how can we create awareness?

B: From my perspective, schools can hold special assemblies, poster contests and invite special athletes to share their stories.

⭐ Nine Gold Medals · Writing Task

I **Write three creative slogans on Special Olympics.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

1. Special Olympics: Every Heart a Champion
2. Different Abilities, One Spirit, Endless Joy
3. Play Together, Win Together

II **Create a poster based on the inspiration you have drawn from the poem.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Poster (inside a box):

- Top: slogan – 'Play Together, Win Together'
- Centre: picture of nine runners holding hands at the finish line
- Sides: 'Kindness is the real gold', 'Support Special Olympics – promote inclusion'
- Bottom: call for action – 'Cheer for every athlete! Join our school's Inclusion Day.'

Use bright colours and few words.

📘 Nine Gold Medals · Learning Beyond the Text

I **Find out more about other Indian achievers of Special Olympics.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Search newspapers and the internet (e.g. Special Olympics Bharat website) for Indian medal winners at the Special Olympics World Games, such as those at Berlin 2023 (Ravimathi Arumugam, Aanchal Goyal, Saket Kundu), and note their sport and medal.

III **Create an infographic on any sport and present it in the class.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Sample – Kabaddi:

- Origin: ancient Indian game, played for centuries
- Teams: 7 players on court each side
- Aim: a raider crosses into the other half, touches defenders and returns in one breath
- Big events: Asian Games, Pro Kabaddi League

Use icons, short facts and colours in boxes.

🎉 **Chapter 5 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**